

You Already Know This Year's Theme: "For The People"

Your challenge is to identify a meaningful problem faced by Namibians and build a **Minimum Viable Product (MVP)** that demonstrates a practical solution.

Remember, this hackathon is **not** about building the biggest or most technically advanced application.

We're looking for solutions that:

- Clearly define a real problem.
- Demonstrate an understanding of who the problem affects.
- Present a practical and well-thought-out solution.
- Deliver a convincing MVP that showcases the core idea.

The Challenge Brief

This year's AWS User Group Windhoek Hackathon theme, "For The People," encourages teams to identify a meaningful problem experienced by individuals, communities, or public institutions, and develop a practical software solution that addresses it.

Instead of building technology for its technology sake, participants are challenged to understand the problem first, identify who it affects, and design an MVP that demonstrates how technology can improve everyday life.



The strongest projects are those that solve problems that are:

- Relevant to Namibia or a specific Namibian community.
- Clearly defined and well understood.
- Practical and achievable within the scope of an MVP.
- Capable of creating measurable value for users.

Projects don't need to solve problems affecting the entire country. A solution that significantly improves the lives of a smaller community, industry, or organization can be just as valuable.

Example Ideas

The following are examples intended to inspire your thinking. They are not challenge prompts:

- A digital tool that improves emergency response or public safety.
- A digital solution that improves access to public services or government information.
- A platform that simplifies access to legal information or public regulations.
- A solution that improves healthcare, elder care, or social services.
- The most successful projects won't necessarily be the most technically complex but are the ones that clearly identify a real problem, create a practical solution, and demonstrate a working MVP that shows how the idea could create value in the real world.

Judging Criteria

Problem & Solution Strategy

- **Problem Definition:** How clearly did the team define the problem, its context, and its impact?
- **Solution Design:** How effectively does the proposed solution address the identified problem? Was the approach logical, practical, and well justified?
- **Implementation:** How well was the solution implemented? Consider ideated functionality, helpfulness, and overall execution of the final product against the provided solution.

Presentation & Roadmap

- **Communication:** How clearly and confidently did the team explain the problem, their solution, and the technical decisions behind it?
- **Deployment Strategy:** How realistic and well thought out is the team's plan for deploying, maintaining, and scaling the solution in a real-world environment?

Product Thinking

- **Innovation & Creativity:** How original or creative is the proposed solution?
- **Functionality:** Does the MVP successfully deliver its core features?
- **Proof of Concept:** Does the prototype demonstrate that the idea is feasible?

Rules

- **Deployment:** Your project must be publicly accessible through an AWS EC2 instance before judging begins.
- **Group Leader:** Each team must designate a Group Leader who will:
 - Serve as the primary point of contact with the team.
 - Lead the project presentation.
 - Ensure the application is deployed and accessible for judging.
- **Presentation Time:** Each team will have 4 minutes to present:
 - The problem statement.
 - The proposed solution.
 - The architecture or technical approach (briefly).
 - A live demonstration of the core MVP features.
- **Presentation Time:** Each team will have 4 minutes to present:
 - The problem statement.
 - The proposed solution.
 - The architecture or technical approach (briefly).
 - A live demonstration of the core MVP features.
- Ensure the deployed application is fully functional before your presentation slot.

Deployment Onto AWS

- **Deployment Platform:** All projects must be deployed to an AWS EC2 instance before the judging session.
- **Primary Contact:** Each team must nominate a Group Leader who will be the only point of contact with the AWS Technical Support Team for deployment-related assistance. This helps ensure clear and consistent communication.
- **Deployment Assistance:** The AWS Technical Support Team will provide guidance on deploying your application to EC2. Teams are expected to perform the deployment themselves, with support available if needed.
- **Containerization (Optional):** Deploying your application using Docker is encouraged, but it is not a requirement.
- **AWS Account:** The Group Leader will need to create an AWS account. AWS requires a valid debit or credit card to verify the account during registration.

The verification card will not be charged as part of the hackathon deployment process. It is required solely for AWS account verification. Teams should still follow the provided AWS guidance to avoid provisioning unnecessary resources outside the scope of the event.

Certificate of Participation

All participants who attend the in-person event on **25 July** as part of a presenting team will receive a **Certificate of Participation**. Attendance on the event day will be used to confirm participation.

Event Day: 25 July

On the day of the hackathon, you'll join us in person to:

- Meet the judges and fellow participants.
- Continue refining and polishing your MVP.
- Network with other developers and technology enthusiasts.
- Receive guidance from mentors and organizers.
- Prepare your final presentation.
- Present your project to the judging panel.
- Celebrate the announcement of the winning teams.

Most Importantly

Come ready to learn, collaborate, meet new people, and have fun!

There will be food, drinks, great conversations, and plenty of opportunities to connect with fellow developers and members of Namibia's growing tech community.

We can't wait to see what you build.

See you on 25 July!